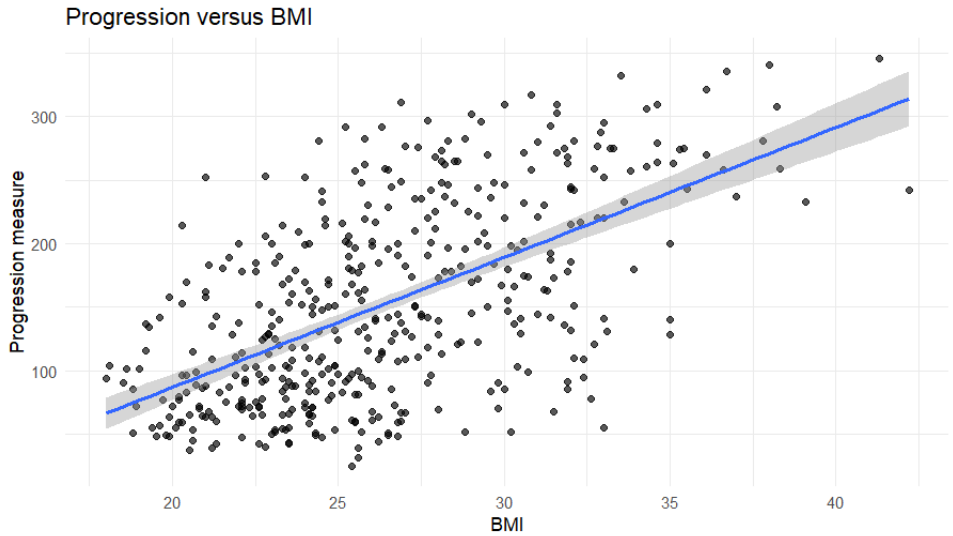
What makes diabetes get worse faster?

A study of 442 patients over one year

Three things stand out



Each dot is one patient.

Patients with higher levels of these got worse faster:

- **Body weight (BMI)**
- **Blood test “s5”**
- **Blood pressure**

How big is the difference?

+32

points for BMI 30
compared with BMI 25

+9

points for 10 units higher
blood pressure

Half

of the differences between
patients is explained

Progression is measured from 25 (little change) to 346 (much worse).

How sure are we?

Sure

These links are real, not chance.

Not sure

- Half of the picture is still missing
- Not accurate enough to predict one patient
- No data on medication, diet or exercise

What to take away

Do

Use BMI, blood pressure and the s5 test to spot patients who may need closer follow-up.

Don’t

- Assume weight loss will slow the disease by a set amount (a link is not proof of cause)
- Use this to predict one patient’s future